P.E.N.Y — User Guide

A simple guide to using P.E.N.Y day-to-day. For how to install or set it up, see the Setup Guide (or the Windows Build Guide) instead — this one is just about using the app once it's running.

Logging In

The first time you open P.E.N.Y, tap **Create one** and enter an email and a password (at least 8 characters).

Straight after signing up, you'll see a recovery code — four groups of four letters and numbers, like `6LZZ-5XNS-7JCV-6KA2`. Write this down somewhere safe (a notebook, not a file on the same computer). It's the only way to get back in if you ever forget your password. Tick the box to confirm you've saved it, then continue to log in.

If more than one person uses P.E.N.Y, everyone can create their own login — you'll all see the same shared information.

Forgotten your password? On the login screen, tap **Reset it** and enter your email, your recovery code, and a new password.

The Dashboard (Home)

This is what you see when you open the app. It shows:

- **Total Net Worth** — everything added together: your accounts, investments, and pensions, with a breakdown underneath
- **This Month In / Out** — what's come in and gone out so far this month
- **Accounts** — a quick list of your account balances
- **Upcoming Bills** — what's due soon

A small dot in the top-right corner shows whether a bank is connected and synced, if you've set that up.

Accounts

Tap **Accounts** at the bottom to see and manage your accounts.

To add an account: tap **+ Add Account**, give it a name (e.g. "Barclays Current"), choose a type (current, savings, credit card, loan, investment, or cash), and enter the balance it has right now.

Investments

Further down the same screen is **Investments** — for stocks, shares, funds, or anything else that isn't a simple account balance.

To add one: tap **+ Add Investment**, give it a name, pick a type, and enter its current value. If you enter what you originally paid for it too, P.E.N.Y will work out your gain or loss automatically.

Transactions

Tap **Transactions** to see everything you've spent or received, most recent first. Use the search box to find something quickly.

To add one: tap the green **+** button, choose which account it's for, pick a category, enter the date and amount (use a minus sign for spending, no minus for money coming in), and add who it was to or from.

Tap any transaction in the list to edit or delete it.

Budgets

Tap **Budgets** to see how your spending compares to what you've planned for each category this month.

To set a budget: tap **+ Set a Budget**, choose a category, and enter how much you want to allow for it that month.

Bills

Tap **Bills** to see your recurring payments — rent, subscriptions, utilities, and so on.

To add one: tap **+ Add Bill**, give it a name, an amount, which day of the month it's due, and how often it repeats.

Plan

This tab is for the bigger picture.

Cashflow Forecast — shows whether your balance is likely to stay healthy over the next 90 days, based on your bills and typical spending.

Pension & Investment Growth — a chart showing how your pensions (green) and investments (cyan) are projected to grow over time, plus a dashed line for the combined total.

Pensions & Retirement — add each pension you have, and P.E.N.Y will combine them into a projected retirement pot and a rough estimated monthly income.

To set this up: tap **Set Retirement Assumptions** and enter your date of birth, a withdrawal rate (4% a year is a common starting point), and your state pension if you know it. Then tap **+ Add Pension** for each pension pot, entering its current value, your and your employer's monthly contributions, an assumed growth rate, and the age you can access it.

A note on all of this: these are estimates based on the numbers you enter, not financial advice or a guarantee. Real growth depends on markets, fees, and tax rules that P.E.N.Y can't know about.

More (Settings)

The **More** tab has everything else:

- **Bank Sync** — connect a bank for read-only transaction syncing (needs a one-off setup by whoever installed P.E.N.Y)
- **Print Summary** — choose a month, year, or 5-year period and print a full summary — net worth, income/expenses, budgets, and bills — on one A4 landscape page
- **Security** — turn on 2FA (a 6-digit code from an authenticator app, in addition to your password) for extra protection
- **Your Data** — export everything as a full backup (JSON), a spreadsheet (CSV), or QIF (for Quicken/Microsoft Money-style software); or import a QIF/OFX file from old software, or restore a P.E.N.Y backup

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A Few Tips

- The green **+** button in the bottom-right always adds whatever makes sense for the screen you're on
- Tap any item in a list (a transaction, account, pension, or investment) to edit or delete it
- Everything you enter stays on your own P.E.N.Y installation — nothing is sent anywhere else unless you specifically turn on bank syncing
- If you're ever unsure what a figure means, the small grey text under most numbers explains it